

BibInVs MN 33

Micah

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 33*

God

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Micah

Micah 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD's Message as it came to Micah of Moresheth. It came during the reigns of Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah. It had to do with what was going on in Samaria and Jerusalem.
- 1 The word of the LORD that came to Micah of Moresheth during the reigns of Jotham, Ahaz and Hezekiah, kings of Judah--the vision he saw concerning Samaria and Jerusalem.
- 2 Listen, people--all of you. Listen, earth, and everyone in it: The Master, GOD, takes the witness stand against you, the Master from his Holy Temple.
- 2 Hear, O peoples, all of you, listen, O earth and all who are in it, that the Sovereign LORD may witness against you, the Lord from his holy temple.
- 3 Look, here he comes! GOD, from his place! He comes down and strides across mountains and hills.
- 3 Look! The LORD is coming from his dwelling place; he comes down and treads the high places of the earth.
- 4 Mountains sink under his feet, valleys split apart; The rock mountains crumble into gravel, the river valleys leak like sieves.
- 4 The mountains melt beneath him and the valleys split apart, like wax before the fire, like water rushing down a slope.
- 5 All this because of Jacob's sin, because Israel's family did wrong. You ask, "So what is Jacob's sin?" Just look at Samaria--isn't it obvious? And all the sex-and-religion shrines in Judah-- isn't Jerusalem responsible?
- 5 All this is because of Jacob's transgression, because of the sins of the house of Israel. What is Jacob's transgression? Is it not Samaria? What is Judah's high place? Is it not Jerusalem?

- 6 "I'm turning Samaria into a heap of rubble, a vacant lot littered with garbage. I'll dump the stones from her buildings in the valley and leave her abandoned foundations exposed.
- 6 Therefore I will make Samaria a heap of rubble, a place for planting vineyards. I will pour her stones into the valley and lay bare her foundations.
- 7 All her carved and cast gods and goddesses will be sold for stove wood and scrap metal, All her sacred fertility groves burned to the ground, All the sticks and stones she worshiped as gods, destroyed. These were her earnings from her life as a whore. This is what happens to the fees of a whore."
- 7 All her idols will be broken to pieces; all her temple gifts will be burned with fire; I will destroy all her images. Since she gathered her gifts from the wages of prostitutes, as the wages of prostitutes they will again be used."
- 8 This is why I lament and mourn. This is why I go around in rags and barefoot. This is why I howl like a pack of coyotes, and moan like a mournful owl in the night.
- 8 Because of this I will weep and wail; I will go about barefoot and naked. I will howl like a jackal and moan like an owl.
- 9 GOD has inflicted punishing wounds; Judah has been wounded with no healing in sight. Judgment has marched through the city gates. Jerusalem must face the charges.
- 9 For her wound is incurable; it has come to Judah. It has reached the very gate of my people, even to Jerusalem itself.
- 10 Don't gossip about this in Telltown. Don't waste your tears. In Dustville, roll in the dust.
- 10 Tell it not in Gath; weep not at all. In Beth Ophrah roll in the dust.
- 11 In Alarmtown, the alarm is sounded. The citizens of Exitburgh will never get out alive. Lament, Last-Stand City: There's nothing in you left standing.
- 11 Pass on in nakedness and shame, you who live in Shaphir. Those who live in Zaanah will not come out. Beth Ezel is in mourning; its protection is taken from you.
- 12 The villagers of Bittertown wait in vain for sweet peace. Harsh judgment has come from GOD and entered Peace City.

- 12 Those who live in Maroth writhe in pain, waiting for relief, because disaster has come from the LORD, even to the gate of Jerusalem.
- 13 All you who live in Chariotville, get in your chariots for flight. You led the daughter of Zion into trusting not God but chariots. Similar sins in Israel also got their start in you.
- 13 You who live in Lachish, harness the team to the chariot. You were the beginning of sin to the Daughter of Zion, for the transgressions of Israel were found in you.
- 14 Go ahead and give your good-bye gifts to Good-byeville. Miragetown beckoned but disappointed Israel's kings.
- 14 Therefore you will give parting gifts to Moresheth Gath. The town of Aczib will prove deceptive to the kings of Israel.
- 15 Inheritance City has lost its inheritance. Glorytown has seen its last of glory.
- 15 I will bring a conqueror against you who live in Mareshah. He who is the glory of Israel will come to Adullam.
- 16 Shave your heads in mourning over the loss of your precious towns. Go bald as a goose egg--they've gone into exile and aren't coming back.
- 16 Shave your heads in mourning for the children in whom you delight; make yourselves as bald as the vulture, for they will go from you into exile.

Micah 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Doom to those who plot evil, who go to bed dreaming up crimes! As soon as it's morning, they're off, full of energy, doing what they've planned.
- 1 Woe to those who plan iniquity, to those who plot evil on their beds! At morning's light they carry it out because it is in their power to do it.
- 2 They covet fields and grab them, find homes and take them. They bully the neighbor and his family, see people only for what they can get out of them.
- 2 They covet fields and seize them, and houses, and take them. They defraud a man of his home, a fellowman of his inheritance.

- 3 GOD has had enough. He says, "I have some plans of my own: Disaster because of this interbreeding evil! Your necks are on the line. You're not walking away from this. It's doomsday for you.
- 3 Therefore, the LORD says: "I am planning disaster against this people, from which you cannot save yourselves. You will no longer walk proudly, for it will be a time of calamity.
- 4 Mocking ballads will be sung of you, and you yourselves will sing the blues: 'Our lives are ruined, our homes and lands auctioned off. They take everything, leave us nothing! All is sold to the highest bidder.'"
- 4 In that day men will ridicule you; they will taunt you with this mournful song: 'We are utterly ruined; my people's possession is divided up. He takes it from me! He assigns our fields to traitors.' "
- 5 And there'll be no one to stand up for you, no one to speak for you before GOD and his jury.
- 5 Therefore you will have no one in the assembly of the LORD to divide the land by lot.
- 6 "Don't preach," say the preachers. "Don't preach such stuff. Nothing bad will happen to us.
- 6 Do not prophesy, their prophets say. "Do not prophesy about these things; disgrace will not overtake us."
- 7 Talk like this to the family of Jacob? Does GOD lose his temper? Is this the way he acts? Isn't he on the side of good people? Doesn't he help those who help themselves?"
- 7 Should it be said, O house of Jacob: "Is the Spirit of the LORD angry? Does he do such things?" "Do not my words do good to him whose ways are upright?"
- 8 "What do you mean, 'good people'! You're the enemy of my people! You rob unsuspecting people out for an evening stroll. You take their coats off their backs like soldiers who plunder the defenseless.
- 8 Lately my people have risen up like an enemy. You strip off the rich robe from those who pass by without a care, like men returning from battle.
- 9 You drive the women of my people out of their ample homes. You make victims of the children and leave them vulnerable to violence and vice.
- 9 You drive the women of my people from their pleasant homes. You take away my blessing from their children forever.

- 10 Get out of here, the lot of you. You can't take it easy here! You've polluted this place, and now you're polluted--ruined!
- 10 Get up, go away! For this is not your resting place, because it is defiled, it is ruined, beyond all remedy.
- 11 If someone showed up with a good smile and glib tongue and told lies from morning to night-- 'I'll preach sermons that will tell you how you can get anything you want from God: More money, the best wines . . . you name it'-- you'd hire him on the spot as your preacher!
- 11 If a liar and deceiver comes and says, 'I will prophesy for you plenty of wine and beer,' he would be just the prophet for this people!
- 12 "I'm calling a meeting, Jacob. I want everyone back--all the survivors of Israel. I'll get them together in one place-- like sheep in a fold, like cattle in a corral-- a milling throng of homebound people!
- 12 I will surely gather all of you, O Jacob; I will surely bring together the remnant of Israel. I will bring them together like sheep in a pen, like a flock in its pasture; the place will throng with people.
- 13 Then I, GOD, will burst all confinements and lead them out into the open. They'll follow their King. I will be out in front leading them."
- 13 One who breaks open the way will go up before them; they will break through the gate and go out. Their king will pass through before them, the LORD at their head."

Micah 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then I said: "Listen, leaders of Jacob, leaders of Israel: Don't you know anything of justice?
- 1 Then I said, "Listen, you leaders of Jacob, you rulers of the house of Israel. Should you not know justice,
- 2 Haters of good, lovers of evil: Isn't justice in your job description? But you skin my people alive. You rip the meat off their bones.
- 2 you who hate good and love evil; who tear the skin from my people and the flesh from their bones;
- 3 You break up the bones, chop the meat, and throw it in a pot for cannibal stew."

- 3 who eat my people's flesh, strip off their skin and break their bones in pieces; who chop them up like meat for the pan, like flesh for the pot?"
- 4 The time's coming, though, when these same leaders will cry out for help to GOD, but he won't listen. He'll turn his face the other way because of their history of evil.
- 4 Then they will cry out to the LORD, but he will not answer them. At that time he will hide his face from them because of the evil they have done.
- 5 Here is GOD's Message to the prophets, the preachers who lie to my people: "For as long as they're well paid and well fed, the prophets preach, 'Isn't life wonderful! Peace to all!' But if you don't pay up and jump on their bandwagon, their 'God bless you' turns into 'God damn you.'"
- 5 This is what the LORD says: "As for the prophets who lead my people astray, if one feeds them, they proclaim 'peace'; if he does not, they prepare to wage war against him.
- 6 Therefore, you're going blind. You'll see nothing. You'll live in deep shadows and know nothing. The sun has set on the prophets. They've had their day; from now on it's night.
- 6 Therefore night will come over you, without visions, and darkness, without divination. The sun will set for the prophets, and the day will go dark for them.
- 7 Visionaries will be confused, experts will be all mixed up. They'll hide behind their reputations and make lame excuses to cover up their God-ignorance."
- 7 The seers will be ashamed and the diviners disgraced. They will all cover their faces because there is no answer from God."
- 8 But me--I'm filled with GOD's power, filled with GOD's Spirit of justice and strength, Ready to confront Jacob's crime and Israel's sin.
- 8 But as for me, I am filled with power, with the Spirit of the LORD, and with justice and might, to declare to Jacob his transgression, to Israel his sin.
- 9 The leaders of Jacob and the leaders of Israel are Leaders contemptuous of justice, who twist and distort right living,
- 9 Hear this, you leaders of the house of Jacob, you rulers of the house of Israel, who despise justice and distort all that is right;

- 10 Leaders who build Zion by killing people, who expand Jerusalem by committing crimes.
- 10 who build Zion with bloodshed, and Jerusalem with wickedness.
- 11 Judges sell verdicts to the highest bidder, priests mass-market their teaching, prophets preach for high fees, All the while posturing and pretending dependence on GOD: "We've got GOD on our side. He'll protect us from disaster."
- 11 Her leaders judge for a bribe, her priests teach for a price, and her prophets tell fortunes for money. Yet they lean upon the LORD and say, "Is not the LORD among us? No disaster will come upon us."
- 12 Because of people like you, Zion will be turned back into farmland, Jerusalem end up as a pile of rubble, and instead of the Temple on the mountain, a few scraggly scrub pines.
- 12 Therefore because of you, Zion will be plowed like a field, Jerusalem will become a heap of rubble, the temple hill a mound overgrown with thickets.

Micah 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 But when all is said and done, GOD's Temple on the mountain, Firmly fixed, will dominate all mountains, towering above surrounding hills. People will stream to it
- 1 In the last days the mountain of the LORD's temple will be established as chief among the mountains; it will be raised above the hills, and peoples will stream to it.
- 2 and many nations set out for it, Saying, "Come, let's climb GOD's mountain. Let's go to the Temple of Jacob's God. He will teach us how to live. We'll know how to live God's way." True teaching will issue from Zion, GOD's revelation from Jerusalem.
- 2 Many nations will come and say, "Come, let us go up to the mountain of the LORD, to the house of the God of Jacob. He will teach us his ways, so that we may walk in his paths." The law will go out from Zion, the word of the LORD from Jerusalem.

- 3 He'll establish justice in the rabble of nations and settle disputes in faraway places. They'll trade in their swords for shovels, their spears for rakes and hoes. Nations will quit fighting each other, quit learning how to kill one another.
- 3 He will judge between many peoples and will settle disputes for strong nations far and wide. They will beat their swords into plowshares and their spears into pruning hooks. Nation will not take up sword against nation, nor will they train for war anymore.
- 4 Each man will sit under his own shade tree, each woman in safety will tend her own garden. GOD-of-the-Angel-Armies says so, and he means what he says.
- 4 Every man will sit under his own vine and under his own fig tree, and no one will make them afraid, for the LORD Almighty has spoken.
- 5 Meanwhile, all the other people live however they wish, picking and choosing their gods. But we live honoring GOD, and we're loyal to our God forever and ever.
- 5 All the nations may walk in the name of their gods; we will walk in the name of the LORD our God for ever and ever.
- 6 "On that great day," GOD says, "I will round up all the hurt and homeless, everyone I have bruised or banished.
- 6 In that day, declares the LORD, "I will gather the lame; I will assemble the exiles and those I have brought to grief.
- 7 I will transform the battered into a company of the elite. I will make a strong nation out of the long lost, A showcase exhibit of GOD's rule in action, as I rule from Mount Zion, from here to eternity.
- 7 I will make the lame a remnant, those driven away a strong nation. The LORD will rule over them in Mount Zion from that day and forever.
- 8 "And you stragglers around Jerusalem, eking out a living in shantytowns: The glory that once was will be again. Jerusalem's daughter will be the kingdom center."
- 8 As for you, O watchtower of the flock, O stronghold of the Daughter of Zion, the former dominion will be restored to you; kingship will come to the Daughter of Jerusalem."
- 9 So why the doomsday hysterics? You still have a king, don't you? But maybe he's not doing his job and you're panicked like a woman in labor.

- 9 Why do you now cry aloud-- have you no king? Has your counselor perished, that pain seizes you like that of a woman in labor?
- 10 Well, go ahead--twist and scream, Daughter Jerusalem. You are like a woman in childbirth. You'll soon be out of the city, on your way and camping in the open country. And then you'll arrive in Babylon. What you lost in Jerusalem will be found in Babylon. GOD will give you new life again. He'll redeem you from your enemies.
- 10 Writhe in agony, O Daughter of Zion, like a woman in labor, for now you must leave the city to camp in the open field. You will go to Babylon; there you will be rescued. There the LORD will redeem you out of the hand of your enemies.
- 11 But for right now, they're ganged up against you, many godless peoples, saying, "Kick her when she's down! Violate her! We want to see Zion grovel in the dirt."
- 11 But now many nations are gathered against you. They say, "Let her be defiled, let our eyes gloat over Zion!"
- 12 These blasphemers have no idea what GOD is thinking and doing in this. They don't know that this is the making of GOD's people, that they are wheat being threshed, gold being refined.
- 12 But they do not know the thoughts of the LORD; they do not understand his plan, he who gathers them like sheaves to the threshing floor.
- 13 On your feet, Daughter of Zion! Be threshed of chaff, be refined of dross. I'm remaking you into a people invincible, into God's juggernaut to crush the godless peoples. You'll bring their plunder as holy offerings to GOD, their wealth to the Master of the earth.
- 13 Rise and thresh, O Daughter of Zion, for I will give you horns of iron; I will give you hoofs of bronze and you will break to pieces many nations. You will devote their ill-gotten gains to the LORD, their wealth to the Lord of all the earth.

Micah 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 But for now, prepare for the worst, victim daughter! The siege is set against us. They humiliate Israel's king, slapping him around like a rag

doll.

- 1 Marshal your troops, O city of troops, for a siege is laid against us. They will strike Israel's ruler on the cheek with a rod.
- 2 But you, Bethlehem, David's country, the runt of the litter-- From you will come the leader who will shepherd-rule Israel. He'll be no upstart, no pretender. His family tree is ancient and distinguished.
- 2 But you, Bethlehem Ephrathah, though you are small among the clans of Judah, out of you will come for me one who will be ruler over Israel, whose origins are from of old, from ancient times.
- 3 Meanwhile, Israel will be in foster homes until the birth pangs are over and the child is born, And the scattered brothers come back home to the family of Israel.
- 3 Therefore Israel will be abandoned until the time when she who is in labor gives birth and the rest of his brothers return to join the Israelites.
- 4 He will stand tall in his shepherd-rule by GOD's strength, centered in the majesty of GOD-Revealed. And the people will have a good and safe home, for the whole world will hold him in respect-- Peacemaker of the world!
- 4 He will stand and shepherd his flock in the strength of the LORD, in the majesty of the name of the LORD his God. And they will live securely, for then his greatness will reach to the ends of the earth.
- 5 And if some bullying Assyrian shows up, invades and violates our land, don't worry. We'll put him in his place, send him packing, and watch his every move.
- 5 And he will be their peace. When the Assyrian invades our land and marches through our fortresses, we will raise against him seven shepherds, even eight leaders of men.
- 6 Shepherd-rule will extend as far as needed, to Assyria and all other Nimrod-bullies. Our shepherd-ruler will save us from old or new enemies, from anyone who invades or violates our land.
- 6 They will rule the land of Assyria with the sword, the land of Nimrod with drawn sword. He will deliver us from the Assyrian when he invades our land and marches into our borders.
- 7 The purged and select company of Jacob will be like an island in the sea of peoples. They'll be like dew from GOD, like summer showers Not mentioned in the weather forecast, not subject to calculation or control.

- 7 The remnant of Jacob will be in the midst of many peoples like dew from the LORD, like showers on the grass, which do not wait for man or linger for mankind.
- 8 Yes, the purged and select company of Jacob will be like an island in the sea of peoples, Like the king of beasts among wild beasts, like a young lion loose in a flock of sheep, Killing and devouring the lambs and no one able to stop him.
- 8 The remnant of Jacob will be among the nations, in the midst of many peoples, like a lion among the beasts of the forest, like a young lion among flocks of sheep, which mauls and mangles as it goes, and no one can rescue.
- 9 With your arms raised in triumph over your foes, your enemies will be no more!
- 9 Your hand will be lifted up in triumph over your enemies, and all your foes will be destroyed.
- 10 "The day is coming" --GOD's Decree-- "When there will be no more war. None. I'll slaughter your war horses and demolish your chariots.
- 10 In that day, declares the LORD, "I will destroy your horses from among you and demolish your chariots.
- 11 I'll dismantle military posts and level your fortifications.
- 11 I will destroy the cities of your land and tear down all your strongholds.
- 12 I'll abolish your religious black markets, your underworld traffic in black magic.
- 12 I will destroy your witchcraft and you will no longer cast spells.
- 13 I will smash your carved and cast gods and chop down your phallic posts. No more taking control of the world, worshiping what you do or make.
- 13 I will destroy your carved images and your sacred stones from among you; you will no longer bow down to the work of your hands.
- 14 I'll root out your sacred sex-and-power centers and destroy the God-defiant.
- 14 I will uproot from among you your Asherah poles and demolish your cities.
- 15 In raging anger, I'll make a clean sweep of godless nations who haven't listened."

15 I will take vengeance in anger and wrath upon the nations that have not obeyed me."

Micah 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Listen now, listen to GOD: "Take your stand in court. If you have a complaint, tell the mountains; make your case to the hills.
- 1 Listen to what the LORD says: "Stand up, plead your case before the mountains; let the hills hear what you have to say.
- 2 And now, Mountains, hear GOD's case; listen, Jury Earth-- For I am bringing charges against my people. I am building a case against Israel.
- 2 Hear, O mountains, the LORD's accusation; listen, you everlasting foundations of the earth. For the LORD has a case against his people; he is lodging a charge against Israel.
- 3 "Dear people, how have I done you wrong? Have I burdened you, worn you out? Answer!
- 3 My people, what have I done to you? How have I burdened you? Answer me.
- 4 I delivered you from a bad life in Egypt; I paid a good price to get you out of slavery. I sent Moses to lead you-- and Aaron and Miriam to boot!
- 4 I brought you up out of Egypt and redeemed you from the land of slavery. I sent Moses to lead you, also Aaron and Miriam.
- 5 Remember what Balak king of Moab tried to pull, and how Balaam son of Beor turned the tables on him. Remember all those stories about Shittim and Gilgal. Keep all GOD's salvation stories fresh and present."
- 5 My people, remember what Balak king of Moab counseled and what Balaam son of Beor answered. Remember your journey from Shittim to Gilgal, that you may know the righteous acts of the LORD."
- 6 How can I stand up before GOD and show proper respect to the high God? Should I bring an armload of offerings topped off with yearling calves?
- 6 With what shall I come before the LORD and bow down before the exalted God? Shall I come before him with burnt offerings, with calves a year old?

- 7 Would GOD be impressed with thousands of rams, with buckets and barrels of olive oil? Would he be moved if I sacrificed my firstborn child, my precious baby, to cancel my sin?
- 7 Will the LORD be pleased with thousands of rams, with ten thousand rivers of oil? Shall I offer my firstborn for my transgression, the fruit of my body for the sin of my soul?
- 8 But he's already made it plain how to live, what to do, what GOD is looking for in men and women. It's quite simple: Do what is fair and just to your neighbor, be compassionate and loyal in your love, And don't take yourself too seriously-- take God seriously.
- 8 He has showed you, O man, what is good. And what does the LORD require of you? To act justly and to love mercy and to walk humbly with your God.
- 9 Attention! GOD calls out to the city! If you know what's good for you, you'll listen. So listen, all of you! This is serious business.
- 9 Listen! The LORD is calling to the city-- and to fear your name is wisdom-- "Heed the rod and the One who appointed it.
- 10 "Do you expect me to overlook obscene wealth you've piled up by cheating and fraud?
- 10 Am I still to forget, O wicked house, your ill-gotten treasures and the short ephah, which is accursed?
- 11 Do you think I'll tolerate shady deals and shifty scheming?
- 11 Shall I acquit a man with dishonest scales, with a bag of false weights?
- 12 I'm tired of the violent rich bullying their way with bluffs and lies.
- 12 Her rich men are violent; her people are liars and their tongues speak deceitfully.
- 13 I'm fed up. Beginning now, you're finished. You'll pay for your sins down to your last cent.
- 13 Therefore, I have begun to destroy you, to ruin you because of your sins.
- 14 No matter how much you get, it will never be enough-- hollow stomachs, empty hearts. No matter how hard you work, you'll have nothing to show for it-- bankrupt lives, wasted souls.
- 14 You will eat but not be satisfied; your stomach will still be empty. You will store up but save nothing, because what you save I will give to the sword.

- 15 You'll plant grass but never get a lawn. You'll make jelly but never spread it on your bread. You'll press apples but never drink the cider.
- 15 You will plant but not harvest; you will press olives but not use the oil on yourselves, you will crush grapes but not drink the wine.
- 16 You have lived by the standards of your king, Omri, the decadent lifestyle of the family of Ahab. Because you've slavishly followed their fashions, I'm forcing you into bankruptcy. Your way of life will be laughed at, a tasteless joke. Your lives will be derided as futile and fake."
- 16 You have observed the statutes of Omri and all the practices of Ahab's house, and you have followed their traditions. Therefore I will give you over to ruin and your people to derision; you will bear the scorn of the nations. "

Micah 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 I'm overwhelmed with sorrow! sunk in a swamp of despair! I'm like someone who goes to the garden to pick cabbages and carrots and corn And returns empty-handed, finds nothing for soup or sandwich or salad.
- 1 What misery is mine! I am like one who gathers summer fruit at the gleaning of the vineyard; there is no cluster of grapes to eat, none of the early figs that I crave.
- 2 There's not a decent person in sight. Right-living humans are extinct. They're all out for one another's blood, animals preying on each other.
- 2 The godly have been swept from the land; not one upright man remains. All men lie in wait to shed blood; each hunts his brother with a net.
- 3 They've all become experts in evil. Corrupt leaders demand bribes. The powerful rich make sure they get what they want.
- 3 Both hands are skilled in doing evil; the ruler demands gifts, the judge accepts bribes, the powerful dictate what they desire-- they all conspire together.
- 4 The best and brightest are thistles. The top of the line is crabgrass. But no longer: It's exam time. Look at them slinking away in disgrace!
- 4 The best of them is like a brier, the most upright worse than a thorn hedge. The day of your watchmen has come, the day God visits you.

Now is the time of their confusion.

- 5 Don't trust your neighbor, don't confide in your friend. Watch your words, even with your spouse.
- 5 Do not trust a neighbor; put no confidence in a friend. Even with her who lies in your embrace be careful of your words.
- 6 Neighborhoods and families are falling to pieces. The closer they are-- sons, daughters, in-laws-- The worse they can be. Your own family is the enemy.
- 6 For a son dishonors his father, a daughter rises up against her mother, a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law-- a man's enemies are the members of his own household.
- 7 But me, I'm not giving up. I'm sticking around to see what GOD will do. I'm waiting for God to make things right. I'm counting on God to listen to me.
- 7 But as for me, I watch in hope for the LORD, I wait for God my Savior; my God will hear me.
- 8 Don't, enemy, crow over me. I'm down, but I'm not out. I'm sitting in the dark right now, but GOD is my light.
- 8 Do not gloat over me, my enemy! Though I have fallen, I will rise. Though I sit in darkness, the LORD will be my light.
- 9 I can take GOD's punishing rage. I deserve it--I sinned. But it's not forever. He's on my side and is going to get me out of this. He'll turn on the lights and show me his ways. I'll see the whole picture and how right he is.
- 9 Because I have sinned against him, I will bear the LORD's wrath, until he pleads my case and establishes my right. He will bring me out into the light; I will see his righteousness.
- 10 And my enemy will see it, too, and be discredited--yes, disgraced! This enemy who kept taunting, "So where is this GOD of yours?" I'm going to see it with these, my own eyes-- my enemy disgraced, trash in the gutter.
- 10 Then my enemy will see it and will be covered with shame, she who said to me, "Where is the LORD your God?" My eyes will see her downfall; even now she will be trampled underfoot like mire in the streets.
- 11 Oh, that will be a day! A day for rebuilding your city, a day for stretching your arms, spreading your wings!

- 11 The day for building your walls will come, the day for extending your boundaries.
- 12 All your dispersed and scattered people will come back, old friends and family from faraway places, From Assyria in the east to Egypt in the west, from across the seas and out of the mountains.
- 12 In that day people will come to you from Assyria and the cities of Egypt, even from Egypt to the Euphrates and from sea to sea and from mountain to mountain.
- 13 But there'll be a reversal for everyone else--massive depopulation--because of the way they lived, the things they did.
- 13 The earth will become desolate because of its inhabitants, as the result of their deeds.
- 14 Shepherd, O GOD, your people with your staff, your dear and precious flock. Uniquely yours in a grove of trees, centered in lotus land. Let them graze in lush Bashan as in the old days in green Gilead.
- 14 Shepherd your people with your staff, the flock of your inheritance, which lives by itself in a forest, in fertile pasturelands. Let them feed in Bashan and Gilead as in days long ago.
- 15 Reproduce the miracle-wonders of our exodus from Egypt.
- 15 As in the days when you came out of Egypt, I will show them my wonders.
- 16 And the godless nations: Put them in their place-- humiliated in their arrogance, speechless and clueless.
- 16 Nations will see and be ashamed, deprived of all their power. They will lay their hands on their mouths and their ears will become deaf.
- 17 Make them slink like snakes, crawl like cockroaches, come out of their holes from under their rocks And face our GOD. Fill them with holy fear and trembling.
- 17 They will lick dust like a snake, like creatures that crawl on the ground. They will come trembling out of their dens; they will turn in fear to the LORD our God and will be afraid of you.
- 18 Where is the god who can compare with you-- wiping the slate clean of guilt, Turning a blind eye, a deaf ear, to the past sins of your purged and precious people? You don't nurse your anger and don't stay angry long, for mercy is your specialty. That's what you love most.

- 18 Who is a God like you, who pardons sin and forgives the transgression of the remnant of his inheritance? You do not stay angry forever but delight to show mercy.
- 19 And compassion is on its way to us. You'll stamp out our wrongdoing. You'll sink our sins to the bottom of the ocean.
- 19 You will again have compassion on us; you will tread our sins underfoot and hurl all our iniquities into the depths of the sea.
- 20 You'll stay true to your word to Father Jacob and continue the compassion you showed Grandfather Abraham-- Everything you promised our ancestors from a long time ago.
- 20 You will be true to Jacob, and show mercy to Abraham, as you pledged on oath to our fathers in days long ago.